

Christian Crumlish

Palo Alto, CA | 415-672-5759 | christian@crumlish.me | linkedin.com/in/mediajunkie

Product Leader

Product executive with 15+ years leading consumer products at scale. Track record of building experiences millions of people use and love—from mental health platforms (7 Cups) to productivity tools (CloudOn → Dropbox) to critical government services (COVID19.ca.gov, 1.5M daily users). Currently pioneering AI-augmented product development through hands-on work with Claude, building systematic methodology for human-AI collaboration. Author of *Product Management for UX People* (Rosenfeld) and co-author of *Designing Social Interfaces* (O'Reilly).

Professional Experience

Director of Product Management | Kind Systems

April 2025 – Present | Palo Alto, CA

Leading AI-powered product development for government digital services, pioneering practical LLM deployment in high-stakes compliance environments.

AI Product Innovation:

- Building **Piper Morgan**, an AI product management assistant using Claude (Opus, Sonnet, Claude Code), developing multi-agent coordination methodology and MCP server integrations
- Architected Claude-powered document intelligence system enabling natural language search across federal compliance documentation
- Establishing AI implementation frameworks across government contracts, introducing responsible AI deployment patterns

Product Strategy:

- Driving product strategy for VA.gov disability claims experience optimization, focusing on user experience improvements for veterans navigating complex benefit processes
- Contributing product expertise to Open Laws (openlaws.org), legaltech applications serving government and legal professionals

Director of Product Management | 18F, General Services Administration

February 2024 – April 2025 | Washington, DC

Led 18 senior consulting product managers driving digital modernization across federal agencies.

- Established organization-wide product management standards, frameworks, and training programs
- Coached executive stakeholders at cabinet agencies on product ownership and digital transformation
- Represented 18F at government and industry events, advocating for user-centric service design
- Spearheaded cross-functional collaboration with design, engineering, and acquisition teams

Deputy Director, Service Innovation | California Office of Data & Innovation

February 2023 – February 2024 | Sacramento, CA

Directed product, design, and engineering teams delivering digital services to millions of Californians.

- Led **Benefits Recommender** expansion: 2M+ Californians reached, 175K+ benefit program referrals—a quasi-consumer product using contextual recommendation patterns
- Implemented OKRs for goal-setting aligned with Government Operations agency
- Managed complex stakeholder relationships across legislators, agency heads, and public interest groups

Product Lead | California Office of Data & Innovation

August 2022 – February 2023 | Sacramento, CA

- **COVID19.ca.gov**: Managed California's primary pandemic information source at **1.5M daily visitors** during peak—rapid iteration, data pipeline management, crisis communication
- **Abortion.ca.gov**: Launched in 6 weeks post-Dobbs, designing for **maximum user privacy and safety** in a politically charged environment
- Led cross-functional teams (research, design, engineering, data) using agile methodologies

VP, Product | 7 Cups

June 2015 – September 2019 | Palo Alto, CA

Built and led product organization for global mental health platform where **user trust was the product**.

- Scaled product team from 2 to 18 (engineers, designers, researchers, PMs)
- Launched paid therapy tier that transformed business model, achieving **profitability without VC funding**
- Platform reached millions of users globally; **320,000+ trained volunteer listeners**
- **Stanford MedicineX Health Systems Design Prize** (2016)
- **World Economic Forum Technology Pioneer** (2019)

Senior Director, Product & UX | CloudOn (acquired by Dropbox)

May 2012 – January 2015 | Mountain View, CA

Led product and design for tablet-first productivity platform through **successful \$100M acquisition by Dropbox**.

- Built design team from scratch; scaled product to **9M+ users**
- Shipped gesture-based document editor and phone product extension
- Led major product redesign and rollout to entire user base

Senior Director, Product Management | AOL

April 2010 – May 2012 | Palo Alto, CA

Consumer product leadership across AOL's portfolio during platform transformation.

- Shipped new version of **AOL Instant Messenger (AIM)**
- Product leadership for **MapQuest**, AOL Mail, Huffington Post, Patch
- Drove product release excellence across multiple consumer platforms

Staff Interaction Designer & Curator | Yahoo Design Pattern Library

January 2007 – March 2010 | Sunnyvale, CA

- Identified and codified UX design patterns for reuse across Yahoo's network
- Member of Design Council reviewing network-wide components
- Built foundation for *Designing Social Interfaces* book

Publications & Thought Leadership

- **Product Management for UX People** – Rosenfeld Media (2022)
 - **Designing Social Interfaces** – O'Reilly Media (2009, 2015) – 75+ academic citations
 - **The Power of Many** – Wiley (2004)
 - **Building Piper Morgan Newsletter** – 725+ subscribers following AI development journey
 - **Design in Product Conference** – Founder and curator with Rosenfeld Media
 - Speaker: UX Lisbon, Code for America Summit, IA Conference, and 20+ industry events
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Volunteer & Community Leadership

- **PathCheck Foundation** (2020-2021) – Product Lead, COVID-19 contact tracing tools, MIT spin-out
 - **Code for America** (2012-2018) – Accelerator mentor for civic tech startups
 - **Rosenfeld Media Fellow** (2015-present) – UX and product thought leadership network
 - **BayCHI Co-Chair** (2009-2015) – Monthly speaker program at PARC
 - **IA Institute Board** (2006-2010) – Elected director, professional community leadership
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Education

Princeton University – Bachelor's Degree, Philosophy

Recognition

- **World Economic Forum Technology Pioneer** (2019) – 7 Cups
- **Stanford MedicineX Health Systems Design Prize** (2016) – 7 Cups
- **Tech Executive Leadership Initiative (TELI)** – Fourth cohort (2023)